



multideck

Calculator Guide

Clear pricing logic for freight, customs, transport and warehouse operations.

WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

- Explains 25 pricing methods in operator language.
- Shows required inputs, calculation behaviour and safeguards.
- Keeps supplier cost and customer sell rules independent by design.
- Provides a common vocabulary for future freight-calculator design.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Pricing methods should be understandable before they are configurable.

CargoWise-style calculator codes and dense forms are deliberately not reproduced here. Multideck uses a plain-language pricing method, context-aware inputs and a readable outcome explanation. The same underlying commercial capability remains available without requiring operators to memorise internal abbreviations.

Independent sides	Supplier cost and customer sell are separate charge lists. Copying creates a new, unlinked charge and requires confirmation.
One source of truth	Every calculation names its quantity, value, tariff, rate source and effective date so its result can be audited.
Explain the outcome	The result panel shows the formula, selected band or rule, inputs used, rounding and any applied minimum or maximum.
Prevent unsafe rating	Missing data, expired tariffs, restricted bands and incompatible units block or warn before a charge is used.

Standard result panel

Every calculator should return the calculated amount in the selected currency, the local/base-currency equivalent, the applied exchange rate, a short calculation explanation and a compact audit trail. The product should show the relevant controls only; advanced constraints are disclosed when the selected method needs them.

CALCULATOR CATALOGUE

25 plain-language pricing methods

#	Pricing method	Primary use
01	Fixed charge	Core pricing
02	Rate per unit	Core pricing
03	Minimum charge	Core pricing
04	Minimum with unit rate	Core pricing
05	Rate bands	Freight pricing
06	Base plus unit rate	Freight pricing
07	Cost-linked sell rule	Commercial controls
08	Tariff adjustment	Commercial controls
09	Customs clearance fee	Customs
10	Percentage uplift	Commercial controls
11	Distance zone pricing	Transport
12	Transport band pricing	Transport
13	First plus additional	Operations
14	Quote note	Presentation
15	Package profile pricing	Warehouse
16	Location profile pricing	Warehouse
17	Time period pricing	Warehouse
18	Percentage bands	Commercial controls
19	Best outcome rate	Freight pricing
20	Disbursement finance charge	Finance
21	Value bands	Commercial controls
22	Volume balance discount	Contract pricing
23	Package count pricing	Operations
24	Release service pricing	Operations
25	Month split storage	Warehouse

Fixed charge

Apply one agreed amount regardless of shipment quantity, weight or volume.

Pricing method	How it behaves
One amount	Result = fixed amount.

Inputs • Charge amount • Charge currency • Scope: shipment, file or service	Operator safeguard Use only where the charge genuinely does not vary with activity. Show the scope so operators know when it applies.
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Example
Documentation fee: GBP 45.00 per shipment.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Rate per unit

Price a charge against a selected measurable unit such as kg, cbm, pallet, container or hour.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Quantity x rate	Result = quantity x unit rate.

Inputs • Rate per unit • Unit of measure • Quantity source	Operator safeguard The quantity source must be explicit: actual weight, chargeable weight, volume, package count or a user-entered figure.
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Example
Handling: USD 0.18 per chargeable kg.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Minimum charge

Protect a minimum return when a calculated rate would otherwise be too low.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Floor	Result = greater of the calculated charge and the minimum.

Inputs • Minimum amount • Applies to: line or shipment • Currency	Operator safeguard Show whether the minimum is assessed per charge line or across a shipment. Do not silently combine unrelated charges.
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Example
Origin handling: minimum GBP 85.00 per shipment.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Minimum with unit rate

Apply a rate per unit while retaining a commercial floor.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Rate with floor	Result = greater of quantity x rate and minimum.

Inputs • Rate per unit • Unit • Minimum amount • Quantity source	Operator safeguard The calculation preview should state which outcome won: the unit rate or the minimum.
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Example
Terminal handling: USD 12.00 per cbm, minimum USD 95.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Rate bands

Apply different rates at defined weight, volume, count or distance thresholds.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Tiered scale	Result follows the matching band, or accumulates across bands when progressive pricing is selected.

Inputs • Band thresholds • Band rates • Unit • Band treatment	Operator safeguard Make the band treatment visible: single winning band, progressive bands, inclusive thresholds or best available rate.
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Example
Air freight: 0-99 kg at USD 4.20; 100-299 kg at USD 3.70; 300+ kg at USD 3.25.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Base plus unit rate

Combine an access or administration amount with a volume-driven charge.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Fixed + variable	Result = base amount + quantity x unit rate.

Inputs • Base amount • Rate per unit • Unit • Quantity source	Operator safeguard Keep the two elements visible in the calculation explanation so an operator can explain the total.
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Example
Collection: GBP 45.00 base plus GBP 0.12 per kg.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Cost-linked sell rule

Create a customer sell charge from an independently sourced supplier cost using an agreed commercial rule.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Margin rule	Sell result = supplier cost adjusted by the selected markup rule.

Inputs • Cost source • Markup percent or amount • Minimum or maximum • Rounding rule	Operator safeguard Supplier and customer charges stay independent. The preview must identify the cost used, timing and whether a manual override exists.
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Example
Carrier surcharge: supplier USD 380.00 plus 12 percent, rounded to nearest USD 1.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Tariff adjustment

Derive a sell or cost rate from a named reference tariff, then apply controlled changes.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Reference uplift	Result starts with the selected tariff outcome, then applies the approved adjustments in the stated order.

Inputs • Reference tariff • Base adjustment • Unit adjustment • Minimum or maximum • Order of operations	Operator safeguard Show the tariff version, effective date and any missing-match warning. Never calculate silently from an unverified tariff.
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Example
Contract sea freight plus USD 15.00 per container and a 5 percent fuel uplift.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Customs clearance fee

Price customs work from declaration type, fee structure, number of entries or number of invoice lines.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Declaration logic	Result follows the selected declaration and line-count structure, subject to its cap.

Inputs • Base clearance fee • Entry type • Included entries or lines • Additional-entry rate • Maximum	Operator safeguard Duties and taxes are separate from the service fee. Show the chosen declaration type and country-specific availability.
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Example
Import clearance: GBP 68.00 including one entry, GBP 14.00 per additional line, capped at GBP 180.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Percentage uplift

Apply a percentage to a defined base such as selected charges, goods value, insured value or customs value.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Percent of value	Result = selected base x percentage, subject to the chosen floor or cap.

Inputs • Percentage • Calculation base • Minimum or maximum • Included charge scope	Operator safeguard The calculation explanation must name every included amount. Operators should never have to infer the percentage base.
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Example
Cargo insurance: 0.38 percent of declared goods value, minimum GBP 25.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Distance zone pricing

Price cartage using origin and destination zones, distance, equipment and optional volumetric conversion.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Zone + distance	Result uses the matching zone pair and the selected distance or quantity bands.

Inputs • Origin and destination zones • Distance source • Vehicle or equipment • Base, bands and minimum	Operator safeguard Identify the route and distance source in the result. A fallback zone must be explicit rather than hidden.
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Example
Bristol to London zone: GBP 95.00 base plus GBP 1.20 per road mile after 35 miles.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Transport band pricing

Apply freight or transport rates by a measure such as chargeable weight, cbm, packages or equipment count.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Mode-aware bands	Result follows the applicable transport band and its stated treatment.

Inputs • Transport mode • Measure source • Bands • Minimum, maximum and restrictions	Operator safeguard Use warnings for out-of-range values, restricted bands and disagreement between rated and invoiced measures.
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Example
LCL freight by cbm with an origin-port restriction.

Multideck interaction pattern

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First plus additional

Charge a different rate for the first item and each additional item.

Pricing method	How it behaves
First item + extras	Result = first-item amount + max(item count - 1, 0) x additional-item amount.

Inputs • First-item amount • Additional-item amount • Item count • Item definition	Operator safeguard Define the counted item clearly: consignment, document, line, pallet or package.
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Example
Delivery booking: GBP 18.00 first booking plus GBP 6.00 per additional booking.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Quote note

Add a controlled explanatory note and optional amount to a customer quote without pretending it is an operational cost.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Text + amount	Result adds the approved text line and optional amount to the selected quote output.

Inputs • Customer-facing description • Optional amount • Visibility setting	Operator safeguard Clearly distinguish a presentation note from a calculated charge. Notes should not create supplier cost or margin automatically.
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Example
Optional weekend delivery cover - GBP 65.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Package profile pricing

Apply warehouse handling rates by package profile, such as full pallet, carton, case or loose unit.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Pack-aware	Result converts the ordered quantity through the approved package hierarchy and applies the matching profile rates.

Inputs • Package profile • Conversion hierarchy • Rate per profile • Quantity source	Operator safeguard Show the conversion path and any remainder so the result can be checked quickly on the warehouse floor.
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Example
Pick: GBP 2.10 per full pallet, GBP 0.34 per carton and GBP 0.08 per loose unit.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Location profile pricing

Apply a charge based on a warehouse location profile, regardless of the product held there.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Location-aware	Result charges each qualifying location once for the configured billing period.

Inputs • Location profile • Rate • Billing period • Occupancy rule	Operator safeguard Avoid double counting mixed-product locations. The guide should state whether a location was active during the period.
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Example
Temperature-controlled bay: GBP 14.00 per occupied location per week.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Time period pricing

Apply time-based storage or service charges by day, week, hour or another agreed period.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Storage time	Result uses elapsed eligible time x the applicable rate or band.

Inputs • Start and end event • Time unit • Bands • Calendar exclusions	Operator safeguard State which events start and stop the clock, and whether weekends and public holidays are excluded.
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Example
Storage: GBP 0.42 per pallet per day after two free days, excluding Sundays.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Percentage bands

Apply different percentage rules at defined value, weight or volume thresholds.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Tiered percent	Result applies the percentage associated with the matching or progressive band.

Inputs • Break thresholds • Percentages • Calculation base • Target charge or group	Operator safeguard Show whether bands are based on values or measures, and list the charges or groups affected.
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Example
Hazardous-goods supplement: 8 percent under GBP 2,000 value, 5 percent at GBP 2,000 and above.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Best outcome rate

Select the highest outcome from independently calculated minimum, weight, volume and fixed-price rules.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Highest charge wins	Result = highest eligible outcome among the configured charge tests.

Inputs • Minimum rate • Weight rate • Volume rate • Flat amount • Multiples	Operator safeguard Show every candidate calculation and clearly identify the winning one. Do not hide a lower alternative.
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Example
Air handling: maximum of GBP 60.00 minimum, GBP 0.35/kg, GBP 85.00/cbm or GBP 45.00 flat.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Disbursement finance charge

Calculate a finance charge for duties, taxes or other disbursements funded before customer settlement.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Time + rate	Result = eligible amount x effective annual rate x eligible days / 365.

Inputs • Prime rate • Uplift • Effective annual rate • Credit terms • Eligible days • Target amount	Operator safeguard Use an approved finance-rate source and show the date, credit terms and whether only overdue days are included.
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Example
Duty advance: 9.5 percent annual rate over 21 eligible days.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Value bands

Apply rate bands based on a declared financial value such as goods, insurance, customs or invoice value.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Value-driven scale	Result uses the selected value source and its matching band.

Inputs • Value source • Breaks • Rates • Minimum or maximum	Operator safeguard The value source must be versioned and visible. Warn when the selected value has not been supplied or is stale.
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Example
Insurance administration: GBP 18.00 below GBP 10,000 goods value; GBP 32.00 at GBP 10,000 and above.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Volume balance discount

Apply an agreed discount when cumulative contracted volume reaches a defined performance threshold.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Period performance	Result uses the achieved average or total contracted volume to determine whether the discount is eligible.

Inputs • Contract • Period • Pivot volume • Discount rate • Eligible jobs	Operator safeguard Show the contract period, contributing shipments and whether the discount is provisional or final.
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Example
ULD air freight discount becomes eligible once monthly average chargeable weight reaches 1,500 kg.

Multideck interaction pattern

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Package count pricing

Combine a base amount, rate per kg, first-package amount and additional-package amount.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Count + weight	Result = base + weight element + first package + additional packages.

Inputs • Base amount • Rate per kg • First-package amount • Additional-package amount • Weight and count	Operator safeguard Display each component in the result so users can check the selected count and weight sources.
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Example
Security screening: GBP 12.00 base, GBP 0.03/kg and GBP 1.50 per package after the first.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Release service pricing

Apply an amount based on the release or collection service requested.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Release type	Result uses the rate assigned to the selected release service.

Inputs • Release service • Rate • Eligibility conditions	Operator safeguard Only show release services that are valid for the shipment, carrier and origin or destination process.
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Example
Express cargo release: GBP 35.00; standard release: GBP 15.00.

Multideck interaction pattern

Choose this pricing method from a plain-language selector. Multideck then reveals only the relevant inputs, validates missing data before rating, and keeps a live explanation beside the result. The charge remains independent on the supplier and customer sides unless an operator explicitly copies it.

Month split storage

Use different storage rates before and after a defined point in the billing month.

Pricing method	How it behaves
Date threshold	Result divides eligible storage time across the configured calendar threshold and applies each rate.

Inputs • Split day • Rate before split • Rate after split • Storage events	Operator safeguard Show the exact date split and the days charged at each rate. This must be tied to the warehouse billing policy.
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Example
Pallet storage: GBP 0.38/day through day 14, then GBP 0.27/day for the remainder of the month.

Multideck interaction pattern

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MODELLING STANDARDS

What every Multideck calculator must carry

Context	Organisation, legal entity, branch, trade lane, service, mode, equipment and the charge side where relevant.
Commercial terms	Currency, tax treatment, rounding, minimum, maximum, effective dates, rate owner and approval status.
Calculation basis	The precise source of weight, volume, distance, time, value, count, tariff or supplier cost.
Outcome	Calculated amount, local/base amount, exchange rate, formula explanation and the winning band or constraint.
Audit	Who created or changed the rule, when it was effective, which inputs were used and why any override occurred.

Design direction

This guide is a product foundation, not a request to expose every option at once. Multideck should introduce calculator methods progressively, prioritising the freight, transport and commercial controls that operators use most. Each new method should reuse the same result panel, audit contract and independent supplier/customer model.